

world's most modern technology first hand.

For a long time flight would remain an uncomfortable, expensive, and unreliable way to travel. It was also unprofitable. No airplane could carry enough passengers to cover costs. When European passenger air services developed after the war, it was less in response to public demand than to the needs of aircraft manufacturers, which, faced with the collapse of the military market at the end of the war, had to find another use for the aircraft they produced. Passenger transportation offered a practical alternative to bankruptcy. It was logical that the French airline Compagnie des Messageries Aériennes should have been created by the joint action of France's leading

airplane makers – Blériot, Farman, Caudron, Morane, Renault, and Breguet. Similarly, in Germany, manufacturers such as Junkers and Albatros were involved in setting up airlines. The ready availability of ex-military pilots and cheap war-surplus airplanes also encouraged adventurous entrepreneurs to try establishing passenger services run on shoestring budgets.

JOY RIDERS

Suitably decked out in goggles, flying helmets, and protective overalls, passengers prepare for a trip in a Standard J-1 in Long Island, New York, in 1927. At that time in the US there was little passenger aviation beyond this primitive level.

